

THE CONCEPT OF THEORY

In the lecture we will start by examine the concept of theory.

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Many theories have been brought into play by many theorists and these theories are rooted to the approach.

Theories begin with empirical observation such as 'sometimes water turns into ice' That is it began as a matter of speculation or idea/opinion leading to empirical studies and theorization. Thus theory emanate from ideas.

Then what is a theory?

A theory can be seen as the substitution of variables of model for real life correspondence in explaining relationships.

Osuala (1991), defines a theory as an attempt at synthesizing and integrating empirical data for maximum classification and unification. According to Eggen Kauchal (2001), as research progresses, results emerge. These results are summarized and patterns in the nature of the results untold. As related principles are formed, this in turn generate further studies as knowledge accumulate, theories are gradually constructed.

A theory is therefore, a set of related principles derived from observation that in turn are used to explain additional observation

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The Importance of theory to Public Administration.

Theory. Claims to explain administrative processes common to many forms of organization (Public or Private).

The detailed study of the theory of administration as an academic discipline is essential as a basic guide towards efficient policy formulation and decisions for optimum utilization of the State resources of the organization (Public/Private).

Theory enable the administrator(s) to cope with the contradictory goals of maintaining a stable ~~pro~~ status quo and adapting to change.

Theory is attempt to accurately describe and to successfully predict relationships among element (variables) of the physical, social and psychological worlds.

Theory help in the integration of the needs of the individual (worker/employee) with the goals of the Management (Public/Private).

Theory help administrator identify the consequences of many governmental actions and their costs.

The future of civilized governments rest upon our ability to develop a Science and Philosophy and Practice of administration Compeled to dis-charge the Public functions of Civilized Society. It is therefore, clearly that Public administration is the life core of the Problem of modern government.

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Administration itself is broad in scope. Its theory therefore draws largely from analyses of various subjects or disciplines particularly the social sciences such as sociology, political science, economics, law and psychology etc.

Administration has been the essence for growth in any system or organisation. Thus, the detailed study of the theory of administration as an academic discipline is essential as a basis guide towards efficient policy formations and decisions for optimum utilizations of the scarce resources of the organisation. The future of civilised government rests upon our ability to develop a science and philosophy and practice of administration competent to discharge the public functions of civilised society.

The origins of administrative theory

The working relationships in factories in the eightieth and ninetieth centuries, made some people to begin thinking and analyzing the positions of both management and workers.

The period of the industrial revolution witnessed a series of inventions of modern technology by different scientists. As a result of these inventions, large complex ^{of} organisations emerged when there were no modern management theories on ground. The task of management was difficult and complex because of lack of trained managers. The owners of these

organisations simply assumed the positions of managers without the necessary backing of modern management principles or theories.

The managers of these organisations bearing in mind that they were the owners of these organisations, did not have the interest of their workers at heart. Their concern was on how to maximise production at the best possible cost for maximum profit. Therefore, workers were subjected to deplorable working conditions. They were not given adequate incentives to motivate them to put in their best.

The resultant effect of poor working condition led to low productivity generally in almost all organisations^s at that time. This became an issue of concern to most contemporaries because even with modern technology, production was still very low. Concerned individuals, scholars, and managers of complex organisations started thinking and developing ideas on how to improve productivity and hence the beginning of management thought. Among other contributors at that time are as follows:-

Robert Owen (1771-1854), he was one of the pioneering industrialists. As a textile manufacturer, he took a genuine interest in the welfare of his workers. For Owen, attention was devoted to employees who he referred to as the vital machines of an organisation.

Andrew Ure: as an entrepreneur of the first half of the 19th century, he believed that workers left to them were lazy and ignorant and that factory employment of the industrial revolution did improve the workers morale and health and gave them higher wages than could be obtained in agriculture or cottage production. However, the spirit of unionism was frowned at according to Ure, it caused violence and crime.

Charles Babbage (1792 - 1871), stressed on mutuality of interests between employer and employee. He believed that hard work and high productivity are a source of good wages for the worker and high profit for the employer.

Adam Smith (1776) emphasized that if each individual work for his own economic self-interest, the greatest good would accrue to society.

The contributions of these individuals ^{UTS} ~~were~~ ~~not~~ very remarkable and ~~not~~ contributed very little in the field of management. The first major contributor that contributed immensely in the field of management was Frederick Winslow Taylor who is considered as the father of scientific management of thought. He opined that there was the need for a scientific approach to work process. He perceived the organisation as a scientific mechanical system that is supposed to work with a high degree of accuracy.

Scientific Management Theory

This school of thought was conceived with how to increase productivity in an organisation through the enhancement of individual worker's efficiency. This efficiency according to this school could be attained by designing the work environment to reduce the number of motions and time spent on a particular task. Frederick Winslow Taylor (1856 - 1915) was the founder and father of this school of thought, Taylor started as a mechanist apprentice with the ^{Medley} ~~Midval~~ steel works. He rose through labour ^{at} ~~an~~ chief engineer of the company.

He used his experience to study the motions on the various tasks as well as designed methods of reducing those motions to ensure the efficiency of the individual worker which will eventually ensure an increase in productivity for the organisation.

Taylor believes that increase in productivity will earn the organisation more profit while it should also increase the income of those workers only that contribute to this increase through bonus. Inefficiency according to him arises from ignorance of both the management not knowing what constitute a 'fair days work' (i.e amount of work expected) and the workers not knowing what constitute a 'fair day's pay' (i.e ^{enough} ~~communist~~ rate wages). This led to a lot of 'soldering' on the job rather than thinking of enhancing an increased

productivity. He further gave basis principles by which productivity can be increased in an organisation. These are:-

- a. Developing a true science of work. This specifying and clearly tell the amount of work to be done by the worker using the simplest and best in performing each task.
- b. Scientific selection and systematic development of the work. This is ensuring that the best worker is given the responsibility for task for which he/she is best suited.
- c. Systematic planning in blending the right and best worker into the developed science of work that is getting the square peg into the square hole to avoid inefficiency.

- d. Ensuring of a constant and intimate cooperation and the workers. *Not antagonism or conflict between the management and the workers.*

DEFINE ORGANISATION

Every human being is involved in organisation. Anytime the behaviour of individual is inter-related to, some form of organisation exist. These organisations varies, as some are large, small, formal, informal, religious, military, political, economic etc.

Organisation is a product of civilization which has evolved since the primitive societies of earliest known human. Since then the basic organisation has been the simple family unit.

In common usage the term organisation means putting things in working order. In public administration this term is used in three different ways. In the first place, it is used as the act of designing the administrative structure in such a way that Mr. 'X' is seen as a great organising leader. In second sense, it is used as designing and building the structure e.g. we say that the minority leader of the house ^{is} in organising the opposition in the state house of Assembly. In the third sense the term refers to administrative structure itself, as when we speak of the organisation of the government of Nigeria, Ghana and Niger. Some think~~e~~ like Urwick confine the use of the term 'organisation' to the first meaning. But many other thinkers, like Gladden, Simon, Heffner etc do not approve of this view and are of the opinion that Urwick has missed the human aspect of organisation. However, different writers have highlighted different aspects of organisation. It is therefore imperative to discuss different definitions of organisation given by different scholars.

"The word organisation is used to denote the construction of the organisation of the result of the administrative structure. Organisation should therefore, mean only designing administrative machine. Urwick (1944) defines

organisation as determining what activities are necessary to any purpose and arranging them in groups which may be assigned to individuals'.

Other definitions given by various scholars are:-

“Organisation in the form of every human association for the attainment of a common purpose” (J. D. Mooney, 1947).

“Organisation is the arrangement of personnel for facilitating the accomplishment of some agreed purpose through allocation of functions and responsibilities (L. M. White 1948).

Organisation structure is a pattern of inter related posts connected by line delegated authority.

“Organisation is the formal structure of authority through which work sub-divisions are arranged, defined and coordinated for the defined objectives” (Luther Gullick, 1937).

Characteristics can be seen as following:

- i. Membership
- ii. Purpose
- iii. Formal Structure

iv. Ideology or value system

v. Corporate status.

DEFINE BUREAUCRACY

Bureaucracy has been derived from the French word bureau meaning a desk.

In the sense that bureaucracy simply means a desk government or rule by administration offices.

Fred from its derogatory sense bureaucracy actually refers to any large-scale organisation of appointed officials whose primary functions is to implement the policies of the decision makers. Jacob describes bureaucracy as a complex system of man, offices, methods and authority which large organisation employ. Bureaucracy is a type of organisation designed to accomplish large-scale administrative tasks by systematically coordinating the work of any individuals. In organised structure that puts laws and policies into effect effectively and efficiently. It is in its non-derogatory sense that the influential German sociologist Max Weber used bureaucracy to accomplish large-scale administrative tasks by systematically coordinating the work of many individuals. In organised structure

THE BUREAUCRATIC MODEL (Ideal type).

The person who gave first systematic analysis of bureaucracy as a specific method of administration was Max Weber (1864-1920). He was born in Germany, qualifies in Law and became a staff of Berlin University, and remained an academic for the rest of his life.

Weber bureaucracy is a formal structure designed for certain administrative purpose. He came up with this model believing that if managers/administrators want to successfully accomplish their desire organisational objectives, they should fashion their organisation based on his ideal model' of bureaucracy. Weber's studies of "organisation theory" and "the development of capitalism" in (1921) are still considered first – rate. His main study is concerned with the sociology of organisation and religion contained in his book "**the protestant ethics and the spirit of capitalism**".

Weber's principal contributions to the study of organisations were his theory of authority structures which led him to characterised organisation in terms of authority relation between them. His simple question was "why do people obey orders from other"?

To deal with this problem, he made a distinction between power which is the ability to force people to obey regardless of their resistance, and authority which is right to give orders to people.

Under an authority system, those in the subordinate see issuing of directives as orders but those in the super-ordinate role see it as legitimate.

Weber distinguished between organisation types according to the way in which authority's legitimised. He then outlines three types of legitimate authority, namely:-

1. Charismatic authority:- The relationship is usually as that of a leader and followers and the mode of exercising authority is based on the personal quality by virtue of which he is set apart from ordinary men and treated as endowed with the supernatural, super human, extra ordinary qualities, transient qualities or at least specially exceptional powers or qualities. E.g (a small scale revolutionary movement of either religions or political nature).
2. Traditional authority:- In this type of authority leadership is based on inheritance and fixed by custom. The moving spirit in such a system is custom. Therefore, under this system, a command might be obeyed out of reverence for the established patterns of order.



There are two types/forms of organisational structure under traditional:-

1. Patrimonial form:- This is through royal kingship or person tied to chiefs or Emirs or Obas as the case may be.

2. Feudal/Non patrimonial form:- this through purely personal loyalties or favourites, where the servants have some autonomy.

3 Legal - Rational or Rational Legal:-
Rational Legal or Legal Rational Authority:- This is derived from

the concept of rational analysis and the apparatus or forms the bureaucratic. →

The system is called rational because the means are expressed designs to achieve specific goals that are the organisation is like a machine with a certain function to perform and every part of the machine contributes to the attainment of the maximum performance of the system. It is legal because authority is exercised by means of a system of rules and procedures through the office which an individual occupies at a particular time. For such an organisation, Weber has given it the name bureaucracy.

The ideal model of bureaucracy, as Weber conceived (imagine) has several definite characteristics as follows:-

1. Division of Labour, in a bureaucratic organisation the total organisational task is broken down into a number of well-defined

specialised functions. Different people will have to assign the various well defined specific jobs. And according to the principles of division of labour, this implies that each position in the hierarchy has its own clearly specified sphere of duties and authority.

2. Hierarchy, Bureaucracy emphasised the principle of hierarchical arrangement of offices. The principles of office hierarchy and levels of graded authority implies a firmly ordered system of super-ordinate – subordinate relationship in which there is a supervision and control of the lower officers by higher ones. Such a system offers the general/rules the opportunity of appealing the decision of higher officers to its highest authority, in a definite regulated manner.

3. Rules and procedures – Bureaucracy operates according to a fixed set of detailed written rules. The entire officials in an organisation are to comply with binding rules and procedures laid down by the organisation. These rules and procedures serve as binding codes of conduct for all classes of workers irrespective of their ranks and profession. E.g civil service rules and regulations the desired organisational goal.

4. Impersonality – This is the distinction between the person and the office he occupied. It simply wants a diverse of personality from the formal

office. Official practices are therefore, source of authority in an office and not the personality likewise, obedience is to the office and not to the person in office e.g Mr. X (a clerk) obey Mr. Y (a Director) not because he is Mr. Y but for the official designation.

5. Merit – Weber emphasized the consideration of merit in all related matters e.g retirement, postings, promotion etc. This will allow the judicious and meritorious employment and he use if workers. It will also disallow favouritism and discrimination based on personal knowledge (connection). This uniform standard should prevail in seeking competence and other staff matters.

6. Records:- In a bureaucratic organisation, administration is based upon written records. These records contained administrative acts, decisions and rules provide a ready reference for future administrative action. The written records (documents) are stored in files access to which are limited and are frequently a source of power. The body of officials and these records and files are up the bureau or office.

The model of bureaucracy assumes that any organisation that operates outside this tent (principle) is disorganised and will not function effectively.

ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES OF BUREAUCRACY

The following can be seen as some advantages of Weber's Bureaucratic

Model:-

1. It requires function and ensures unity within the purview of the organisation.
2. It eliminates personal affairs from official business.
3. Speed knowledge of files, ensures precision and legality.
4. It ensures impartiality amongst officials.

The above mentioned points among others can be considered deemed as a well known fact that most large complex public/private organisations are built on.

However

Below are some of the disadvantages of Max Weber's Bureaucracy.

1. It lacks practical base because it is too rigid.
2. The ideology is not universality but based on capitalist societies.
3. It may lead to lack of commitment and insensitivity.
4. It ignores the human side of administration.

The use of bureau (files) makes bureaucracy an enviable model.

BUREAUCRACY AS A PROCESS OF ADMINISTRATION IN NIGERIA.

Bureaucracy as the specific set of structural arrangement and it is also the setting of a specific pattern of behaviour in an organisation. This according to Max Weber will ensure efficiency and effectiveness of organisation. Bureaucracy emerged on the need for orderliness in an organisation thereby becoming the most effective way of stamping out favouritism, arbitrary use of authority, and discrimination performance in any organisation that applies the bureaucracy model. Nigeria today and most countries and large complex organisations apply partly or wholly the Weberian Model. Its application in Nigeria started in the early 1950's under the British Colonial administration to date.

THE PRINCIPLES OF FORMAL ORGANISATION

Basically the assumption is that

- * All formal organisations have a specified purpose or objectives, and structure of those organisations are designed in such a way that the organisational objectives could be achieved with minimum overlapping of tasks. Urwick (1937) has presented certain principles of organisational structure but which exclude considerations of personalities and individual.

Fayol's one major principle relates to assigning a place for everything and putting everything in its place. These and other principles overlook the importance of the personality factor in the organisational setting..

* Task specialisation: Another organisational principle relates to task or work specialisation. It indicated that if efforts are concentrated on a limited field of endeavour then the quality and quantity of output will increase, the underlying assumption is that specialisation increases the human skill to perform better on the job.

* Chain of command:- The principle of task specialisation will lead to the plurality of tasks. A pattern of parts must be formal so that the inter-relationship among the parts may facilitate the working of the total organisation. The planners should undertake up on themselves the primary responsibility of controlling directing and coordinating the operations of the various parts and of ensuring that each part performs its objective adequately. Administrative and organisational efficiency can be increased if the parts are arranged in a hierarchy of authority, where the parts at the top can direct the parts at the bottom.

* Unity of Direction: Unity of direction takes place where we have specialised single activity. The principles indicate that organisational and

administrative efficiency increases if each unit has a single activity that is well planned and directed by the leader.

Agyris concludes that putting the models of personality and formal organisation side by side, we find certain basic disagreement between the needs of the organisation and the psychological needs of the individual.

Formal organisations create situation where employees:-

- a. Are provided with minimum control over their work day.
- b. Are expected to have a short time perspective.
- c. Are expected to have frequent use of a few skin surface shallow abilities.
- d. Are expected to have short time perspective *(Repealed)*
- e. Are expected to produce under conditions leading to psychological failure. Thus, formal organisations make people feel dependent, submissive and passive and require them to utilise only a few of their less important abilities.

THE GENERAL SYSTEM/SYSTEM APPROACH

This approach is merely a way of thinking about components in organisations and their relation in an organisation for achieving goals and objectives.

Herbert A. Simon is one of the exponents of this approach contends that an organisation is a total system. That is a composite of all subsystems serving to produce the desired effect. His basic assumption is that the elements of organisational structure and function emanate from the characteristic of human problem-solving processes and rational human choice. The systems approach in an organisation is based on the observation that in an organised system, the behaviour of any part ultimately affects the activities of every part of the organisation. Therefore, the essence of this approach is to systematically and diligently search for significant interaction with proper evaluation of actions and policies of each subsystem in relation to the organisation as a whole. Moreover, this approach (i.e. system) will enable the administrator or manager to assign duties to various foremenships that will coordinate the subsystems and ensure its wellbeing for the attainment of organisational goals and objectives.

The systems theory/approach is an integrative approach. It tries to integrate the various schools of management or the various approaches into a cohesive whole.

A change in one subsystem can cause change in the others which can affect the attributes of the whole. In order, to understand the system, a holistic view must be made because the various subsystems are